Special Needs Co-Parenting Assessment Workbook

This 8-step workbook is a private planning tool. It is not a diagnosis, is not a finding of parental fitness, and is not legal advice. Complete it from your own perspective.

Response scale

1. Strongly disagree
2. Disagree
3. Unsure
4. Agree
5. Strongly agree

na. Not applicable or unknown

Step 1. Understand the Concern

Medical Needs

Describe the medical concern you want to address (e.g. a chronic condition, allergy, medication, therapy, or upcoming procedure).

Roughly how long has this been a concern?

[ ] Less than 3 months
[ ] 3 to 12 months
[ ] 1 to 3 years
[ ] More than 3 years

This concern currently affects my child's daily life.

Circle one: 1 2 3 4 5 or N/A

How time-sensitive is this concern?

[ ] Immediate / crisis
[ ] Needs attention within weeks
[ ] Longer-term planning
[ ] Ongoing / stable

Educational Needs

Describe the educational concern you want to address (e.g. school performance, an IEP or Section 504 plan, attendance, or a specific classroom issue).

Roughly how long has this been a concern?

[ ] Less than 3 months
[ ] 3 to 12 months
[ ] 1 to 3 years
[ ] More than 3 years

This concern currently affects my child's daily life.

Circle one: 1 2 3 4 5 or N/A

How time-sensitive is this concern?

[ ] Immediate / crisis
[ ] Needs attention within weeks
[ ] Longer-term planning

[ ] Ongoing / stable

Psychological or Behavioural Needs

Describe the psychological or behavioural concern you want to address (e.g. ADHD, anxiety, depression, an autism-related need, or a specific behaviour pattern).

Roughly how long has this been a concern?

[ ] Less than 3 months
[ ] 3 to 12 months
[ ] 1 to 3 years
[ ] More than 3 years

This concern currently affects my child's daily life.

Circle one: 1 2 3 4 5 or N/A

How time-sensitive is this concern?

[ ] Immediate / crisis
[ ] Needs attention within weeks
[ ] Longer-term planning
[ ] Ongoing / stable

Step 2. Identify the Child's Current Needs

Medical Needs

Which of the following describe your child's current needs? Select all that apply.

- [ ] Chronic medical condition
- [ ] Medication schedule
- [ ] Allergies or dietary restrictions
- [ ] Specialist appointments
- [ ] Medical testing or procedures
- [ ] Physical therapy
- [ ] Occupational therapy
- [ ] Nutritional or feeding support
- [ ] Emergency-care plan
- [ ] Health-insurance coordination
- [ ] Medical-expense coordination

Anything else about your child's current needs that we should note?

Educational Needs

Which of the following describe your child's current needs? Select all that apply.

- [ ] Learning difficulty or developmental delay
- [ ] Kindergarten readiness
- [ ] Academic performance
- [ ] School attendance
- [ ] Educational evaluation or testing
- [ ] IEP or Section 504 services
- [ ] Tutoring or academic support
- [ ] Classroom accommodations
- [ ] Behaviour plan at school
- [ ] Communication with teachers
- [ ] Special events or field trips
- [ ] Extracurricular activities

Anything else about your child's current needs that we should note?

Psychological or Behavioural Needs

Which of the following describe your child's current needs? Select all that apply.

- [ ] ADHD-related supports
- [ ] Anxiety-related supports
- [ ] Depression-related supports
- [ ] Autism-related supports
- [ ] Emotional-regulation strategies
- [ ] Behavioural intervention plan
- [ ] Counselling or psychotherapy
- [ ] Psychiatric medication monitoring
- [ ] Psychological or neuropsychological evaluation
- [ ] Crisis-response plan
- [ ] Communication with therapists

Anything else about your child's current needs that we should note?

Step 3. Review Professional Recommendations

Medical Needs

Who is currently involved with this concern? Include every paediatrician, specialist, or therapist who has evaluated or is treating your child.

- [ ] Paediatrician
- [ ] Family physician
- [ ] Specialist physician
- [ ] Psychologist
- [ ] Psychiatrist
- [ ] Therapist or counsellor
- [ ] Occupational therapist
- [ ] Physical therapist
- [ ] Speech-language pathologist
- [ ] Teacher
- [ ] School counsellor
- [ ] IEP or 504 team

What is the most recent medical recommendation for your child? Summarise it in your own words.

Do you have the recommendation in writing (report, plan, prescription, IEP, etc.)?

- [ ] Yes
- [ ] Partly
- [ ] No
- [ ] Unsure

I understand the current recommendations for my child.

Circle one: 1 2 3 4 5 or N/A

Educational Needs

Who is currently involved with this concern? Include every teacher, school counsellor, IEP team, or educational specialist who has evaluated or is treating your child.

- [ ] Paediatrician
- [ ] Family physician
- [ ] Specialist physician
- [ ] Psychologist
- [ ] Psychiatrist
- [ ] Therapist or counsellor
- [ ] Occupational therapist
- [ ] Physical therapist
- [ ] Speech-language pathologist

[ ] Teacher
[ ] School counsellor
[ ] IEP or 504 team

What is the most recent educational recommendation for your child? Summarise it in your own words.

Do you have the recommendation in writing (report, plan, prescription, IEP, etc.)?

[ ] Yes
[ ] Partly
[ ] No
[ ] Unsure

I understand the current recommendations for my child.

Circle one: 1 2 3 4 5 or N/A

Psychological or Behavioural Needs

Who is currently involved with this concern? Include every psychologist, therapist, psychiatrist, or behavioural specialist who has evaluated or is treating your child.

[ ] Paediatrician
[ ] Family physician
[ ] Specialist physician
[ ] Psychologist
[ ] Psychiatrist
[ ] Therapist or counsellor
[ ] Occupational therapist
[ ] Physical therapist
[ ] Speech-language pathologist
[ ] Teacher
[ ] School counsellor
[ ] IEP or 504 team

What is the most recent clinical recommendation for your child? Summarise it in your own words.

Do you have the recommendation in writing (report, plan, prescription, IEP, etc.)?

[ ] Yes
[ ] Partly
[ ] No

[ ] Unsure

I understand the current recommendations for my child.

Circle one: 1 2 3 4 5 or N/A

Step 4. Each Parent's Understanding

Medical Needs

Both parents have received the same written information about this concern.

Circle one: 1 2 3 4 5 or N/A

Both parents attend key appointments, meetings, or evaluations.

Circle one: 1 2 3 4 5 or N/A

My co-parent and I can discuss this concern openly and calmly.

Circle one: 1 2 3 4 5 or N/A

My co-parent and I use the same words when describing the concern to our child.

Circle one: 1 2 3 4 5 or N/A

I believe my co-parent understands what our child is going through.

Circle one: 1 2 3 4 5 or N/A

Educational Needs

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Circle one: 1 2 3 4 5 or N/A

I believe my co-parent understands what our child is going through.

Circle one: 1 2 3 4 5 or N/A

Step 5. Coordination Between Homes

Medical Needs

Daily routines that affect this concern (medication, bedtime, homework, therapy practice) are consistent across both homes.

Circle one: 1 2 3 4 5 or N/A

Professional recommendations are followed in both homes.

Circle one: 1 2 3 4 5 or N/A

My co-parent and I share updates about appointments, changes, and new information promptly.

Circle one: 1 2 3 4 5 or N/A

Supplies the child needs (medication, adaptive equipment, homework, comfort items) travel reliably between homes.

Circle one: 1 2 3 4 5 or N/A

Transitions and handoffs happen without disrupting the plan.

Circle one: 1 2 3 4 5 or N/A

Educational Needs

Daily routines that affect this concern (medication, bedtime, homework, therapy practice) are consistent across both homes.

Circle one: 1 2 3 4 5 or N/A

Professional recommendations are followed in both homes.

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Circle one: 1 2 3 4 5 or N/A

Transitions and handoffs happen without disrupting the plan.

Circle one: 1 2 3 4 5 or N/A

Step 6. Agreement and Disagreement

Medical Needs

Where do you and your co-parent clearly agree on this concern?

Where do you and your co-parent see it differently?

Which type of gap best describes the disagreement?

- [ ] Different information
- [ ] Different priorities
- [ ] Different parenting styles
- [ ] Communication breakdown
- [ ] No meaningful disagreement

Educational Needs

Where do you and your co-parent clearly agree on this concern?

Where do you and your co-parent see it differently?

Which type of gap best describes the disagreement?

- [ ] Different information
- [ ] Different priorities
- [ ] Different parenting styles
- [ ] Communication breakdown
- [ ] No meaningful disagreement

Psychological or Behavioural Needs

Where do you and your co-parent clearly agree on this concern?

Where do you and your co-parent see it differently?

Which type of gap best describes the disagreement?

- [ ] Different information
- [ ] Different priorities
- [ ] Different parenting styles
- [ ] Communication breakdown
- [ ] No meaningful disagreement

Step 7. Practical Co-Parenting Options

Medical Needs

Select the practical options you would consider trying. You can pick more than one.

- [ ] Shared calendar for medical appointments
- [ ] Shared medication log (paper or app)
- [ ] Pillbox or dispenser used consistently in both homes
- [ ] Emergency-care instructions posted in both homes
- [ ] Both parents added to the patient portal
- [ ] Copy of prescriptions kept in each home
- [ ] Shared travel supply (spare inhaler, EpiPen, etc.)
- [ ] Alternating attendance at appointments
- [ ] Both parents attend key appointments together
- [ ] Third-party liaison (nurse, care coordinator)

Any other practical option you would like to propose?

Educational Needs

Select the practical options you would consider trying. You can pick more than one.

- [ ] Both parents on the school contact list
- [ ] Duplicate report cards and school communications sent to each parent
- [ ] Shared homework folder that travels between homes
- [ ] Alternating attendance at parent-teacher conferences
- [ ] Both parents attend IEP or 504 meetings
- [ ] Shared school calendar (events, holidays, exam dates)
- [ ] Written homework routine agreed in both homes
- [ ] Neutral educational liaison or advocate
- [ ] School-provided planner used consistently in both homes
- [ ] Both parents review the IEP or 504 plan together

Any other practical option you would like to propose?

Psychological or Behavioural Needs

Select the practical options you would consider trying. You can pick more than one.

- [ ] Consistent bedtime and morning routines in both homes
- [ ] Shared behaviour or reward system

- [ ] Consistent screen-time rules
- [ ] Shared coping-skills toolkit that travels with the child
- [ ] Both parents on the therapist's release-of-information
- [ ] Alternating attendance at therapy sessions
- [ ] Written crisis-response plan posted in both homes
- [ ] Shared calendar for therapy and medication
- [ ] Third-party parent-coach or family therapist
- [ ] Neutral communication channel for behavioural updates

Any other practical option you would like to propose?

Step 8. Create an Action Plan

Medical Needs

What is the single most important thing to address in the next 30 days?

When could you and your co-parent meet (or send a written proposal) to discuss this plan?

- [ ] This week
- [ ] Within 2 weeks
- [ ] Within a month
- [ ] Undecided

Which paediatrician, specialist, or therapist would be most useful to consult next, and about what?

Are there any concerns about the plan you would like to raise before finalising it?

Educational Needs

What is the single most important thing to address in the next 30 days?

When could you and your co-parent meet (or send a written proposal) to discuss this plan?

- [ ] This week
- [ ] Within 2 weeks
- [ ] Within a month
- [ ] Undecided

Which teacher, school counsellor, IEP team, or educational specialist would be most useful to consult next, and about what?

Are there any concerns about the plan you would like to raise before finalising it?

Psychological or Behavioural Needs

What is the single most important thing to address in the next 30 days?

When could you and your co-parent meet (or send a written proposal) to discuss this plan?

- [ ] This week
- [ ] Within 2 weeks
- [ ] Within a month
- [ ] Undecided

Which psychologist, therapist, psychiatrist, or behavioural specialist would be most useful to consult next, and about what?

Are there any concerns about the plan you would like to raise before finalising it?